

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥4

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦10

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥8

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥J

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 3
♥ J 10
♦ K Q 6 3
♣ A J 6 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J 2

♣ K 10 9 5



♠ J 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ Q 3

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ 10 8 4

♣ 8 7 4

This time NORTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

NORTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
2NT by North			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ J 4 2

♣ 9 8 7 3

♠ 10 5 3

♥ K 9 7 6 4 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K Q 6

♥ A J 10 3

♦ A Q

♣ K J 5 2

♠ A 9 8

♥ Q

♦ K 10 9 8 6

♣ A Q 10 4

EAST has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

WEST adds her 2 points to EAST's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♦ 10

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 5 4
♥ K 6 5 4 3
♦ A 7
♣ A 5 3

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9 2

♥ J 8

♦ 6 5 3 2

♣ 6 4 2

♠ A 10 8

♥ A 10 9

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ K 9 7

SOUTH has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

NORTH has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking SOUTH to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But SOUTH has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥ 4			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J
♥ A 4
♦ K Q 10 8
♣ A J 7 3

♠ A 5 4

♥ Q J 3

♦ J 6 3 2

♣ 10 9 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 6 2

♥ K 7 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K Q 6

♠ 8 7 3

♥ 10 9 8 6 2

♦ A 7

♣ 5 4 2

West

2NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♥Q

North

Pass

East

3NT

South

WEST has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

EAST has 8 points. She adds WEST's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and WEST passes.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 6 5
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ 10
♣ A 10 6 5

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ K 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 3 2

♥ A 8 4

♦ 9 8 7 4 3

♣ 9 4

♠ A 10 8

♥ K J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ Q J 7 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass			
4NT by North			
Lead: ♥8			

NORTH has a low-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 16 points; he figures the partnership holds either 31, 32 or 33. Obviously he wants to at least reach game, but if NORTH holds 17 points he wants to reach slam.

SOUTH bids 4NT. Since this is more than game it should be clear to NORTH that he is asking her to bid 6NT if she is at the top of her range. It is clear to NORTH, but with just 15 points she passes.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ K J 3
♣ K 10 5 2

♠ J 9 7 6

♥ A 4

♦ A 9 5 4 2

♣ 8 4



♠ A Q 5

♥ K 8 5

♦ Q 10 7 6

♣ A 9 7

♠ K 3 2

♥ J 10 9 3 2

♦ 8

♣ Q J 6 3

EAST has a minimum 1NT opening hand - balanced distribution with 15 points.

WEST has 9 points, which is not enough to bid game, but is worth making an invitational bid. So she says 2NT.

Since EAST is minimum he declines the invitation by passing.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♥J